

Chapter 3: Commercial products

We create new commercial products and networks to meet member needs for affordable and quality care. We offer a variety of fully insured and self-funded commercial products for small and large groups. We also have individual benefit plans. These products vary by network size and make-up, gated or nongated requirements and benefit structure.

Individual Exchange plans

We offer commercial products on the Individual or Small Business Health Options Program (SHOP) Exchange in some states. Commercial products on the Individual and SHOP Exchange follow the same policies and protocols within this guide, unless otherwise stated in your Agreement.

For Individual Exchange in AL, AZ, FL, GA, IA, IL, IN, KS, LA, MA, MD, MI, MO, MS, NC, NE, NJ, NM, NY, OH, OK, SC, TN, TX, VA, WA, WI, WY, refer to [Chapter 4: Individual Exchange plans](#).

Understanding your network participation status

You are contracted to see all commercial members (including Exchange), unless your Agreement excludes you. This includes new benefit plans brought into your market after the effective date of your Agreement. UnitedHealthcare Individual Exchange Benefit Plans require you to have a location in a limited geographic market called the Individual Exchange Benefit Plans network service area. Verify the current Individual Exchange Benefit Plans network service area at [UHCprovider.com/plans](#).

Commercial networks

Each commercial product has a network of health care providers we work with to provide more affordable, quality health care. The following benefit plans include a subset of our commercial network care providers: Charter, Compass, Core, Doctors Plan, Individual Exchange, Navigate, NexusACO and Select. A list of participating health care providers by benefit plan is on [UHCprovider.com/findprovider](#). Your Agreement requires you to coordinate care with other participating network providers. Do not engage non-network providers in a member’s care.

Commercial product overview table

Product name ¹	How do members access physicians and health care professionals? ²	Is a referral required from the member’s PCP to the network specialist?	Is the treating network physician and/or facility required to give notification when providing certain services?
UnitedHealthcare Choice and Choice Plus	Members can seek care from any Choice network physician or health care professional without a referral and without designating a PCP. In some instances, you may see the PCP on the member’s ID card. UnitedHealthcare Choice Plus provides out-of-network benefits. UnitedHealthcare Choice does not cover out-of-network services (except for emergency services).	No, members have open access to a national network of Choice health care providers.	Yes, on selected procedures as described in Chapter 7: Medical management of this guide.

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Product name ¹	How do members access physicians and health care professionals? ²	Is a referral required from the member's PCP to the network specialist?	Is the treating network physician and/or facility required to give notification when providing certain services?
UnitedHealthcare Doctors Plan and Doctors Plan Plus	Members choose, or are assigned, a Doctors Plan network PCP for each family member. Members are encouraged to see their PCP to coordinate their care, but are not required to see that PCP, or to obtain a referral from a PCP when accessing a Doctors Plan network specialist or facility for care. UnitedHealthcare Doctors Plan Plus provides out-of-network benefits. UnitedHealthcare Doctors Plan does not cover out-of-network services (except for emergency services).	No, members have open access to a limited network of Doctors Plan health care providers available nationally.	Yes, on selected procedures, as described in Chapter 7: Medical management of this guide.
UnitedHealthcare Select and Select Plus	Members choose, or are assigned, a Select network PCP for each family member. Members are encouraged to see their PCP to coordinate their care, but are not required to see that PCP, or to obtain a referral from a PCP when accessing a Select network specialist or facility for care. UnitedHealthcare Select Plus provides out-of-network benefits. UnitedHealthcare Select does not cover out-of-network services (except for emergency services).	No, members have open access to a national network of Select health care providers.	Yes, on selected procedures, as described in Chapter 7: Medical management of this guide.
UnitedHealthcare Options PPO	Members can seek care from any Options PPO network physician or health care professional without a referral and without designating a PCP. In some instances, you may see the PCP on the member's ID card. Options PPO provides out-of-network benefits.	No, members have open access to a national network of Options PPO health care providers.	This may be the obligation of the provider or the member and will depend on the member's benefit plan.
UnitedHealthcare Indemnity	Members can choose any physician or health care professional.	No, members have open access to any health care provider.	No, members are responsible for notifying us using the phone number on their health plan ID card.



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Product name ¹	How do members access physicians and health care professionals? ²	Is a referral required from the member's PCP to the network specialist?	Is the treating network physician and/or facility required to give notification when providing certain services?
UnitedHealthcare Core and Core Essential	Members can choose any Core network physician or health care professional without a referral and without designating a PCP. Core provides out-of-network benefits. Core Essential does not (except for emergency services).	No, members have open access to a limited network of health care providers available nationally.	Yes, on selected procedures, as described in Chapter 7: Medical management of this guide.
UnitedHealthcare Freedom Plans Granite Advantage/Saver EPO, Granite Advantage EPO OA and Granite Advantage/Saver PPO OA	Members must select a PCP for the EPO plan and have electronic referrals submitted to UnitedHealthcare by their PCP before seeing another Freedom network physician. For EPO OA and PPO OA plans, members can choose to see any network physician without a referral or designating a PCP. The PPO OA plan provides out-of-network benefits. The EPO plans do not (except for emergency services).	No, referrals are not required on Granite Advantage EPO OA and Granite Advantage/Saver PPO OA plans. Yes, referrals are required on Granite Advantage/Saver EPO plans. An electronic referral from the member's PCP is required prior to receiving services from a participating physicians in the Freedom network. See Chapter 6: Referrals of this guide.	Yes, on selected procedures, as described in Chapter 7: Medical management of this guide.
UnitedHealthcare Navigate, Navigate Balanced Navigate Plus	Members must see their PCP and have electronic referrals submitted to UnitedHealthcare by their PCP before seeing another UnitedHealthcare Navigate® network physician. Navigate Balanced® and Plus benefit plans provide additional network coverage, at a higher member cost-share, for services from a Navigate network physician other than the member's PCP without a referral. Navigate Plus® provides out-of-network benefits. ³ Navigate and Navigate Balanced do not (except for emergency services).	Yes, an electronic referral from the member's PCP is required prior to receiving services from a Navigate physician participating in this limited Navigate network. See Chapter 6: Referrals of this guide.	Yes, on selected procedures, as described in Chapter 7: Medical management of this guide.



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Product name ¹	How do members access physicians and health care professionals? ²	Is a referral required from the member's PCP to the network specialist?	Is the treating network physician and/or facility required to give notification when providing certain services?
UnitedHealthcare Charter, Charter Balanced, Charter Plus	Members must see their PCP and have electronic referrals submitted by their PCP before seeing another UnitedHealthcare Charter® network physician to receive the highest level of coverage. Charter Balanced® and Charter Plus® benefit plans provide additional network coverage, at a higher member cost-share, for services from a Charter network physician other than the member's PCP without a referral. Charter Plus provides out-of-network benefits. Charter and Charter Balanced do not (except for emergency services).	Yes, an electronic referral from the member's PCP is required prior to receiving services from a Charter health care provider participating in this limited Charter network. See Chapter 6: Referrals of this guide.	Yes, on selected procedures, as described in Chapter 7: Medical management of this guide.
UnitedHealthcare Compass, Compass Balanced, Compass Plus	Members must see their PCP and have electronic referrals submitted by their PCP before seeing another Compass network physician within the Compass network service area to receive the highest level of coverage.⁴ Compass Balanced and Plus benefit plans provide network coverage at a higher member cost-share for services from a network physician other than the member's PCP without a referral. Compass Plus provides out-of-network benefits. Compass and Compass Balanced do not (except for emergency services).	Yes, an electronic referral from the member's PCP is required prior to receiving services from a Compass health care provider participating in this limited Compass network. See Chapter 6: Referrals of this guide.	Yes, on selected procedures, as described in Chapter 7: Medical management of this guide.
Individual Exchange Plans	Plans are sold on the Exchange marketplace. Members choose, or are assigned, a network PCP for each family member. Members must see a network PCP to coordinate care. In some states, members must obtain a referral from a PCP when accessing a network specialist for care. Individual Exchange plans do not provide out-of-network benefits (except for emergency services) and members must stay within a defined service area to access care. See Chapter 4 for more information on Individual Exchange plans.	Referrals are required in some states.	Yes, on selected procedures, as described in Chapter 7: Medical management of this guide.



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Product name ¹	How do members access physicians and health care professionals? ²	Is a referral required from the member's PCP to the network specialist?	Is the treating network physician and/or facility required to give notification when providing certain services?
UnitedHealthcare NexusACO OA NexusACO OAP	NexusACO OA® is a tiered benefit plan where members choose, or are assigned, a network PCP for each family member. The member is encouraged to see their PCP to coordinate their care, but is not required to see that PCP, or obtain a referral when accessing other network providers. NexusACO OAP® is a tiered benefit plan and provides out-of-network benefits. NexusACO OA does not cover out-of-network services (except for emergency services). All NexusACO benefit plans are tiered.	No, members have open access to a national network of health care providers.	Yes, on selected procedures, as described in Chapter 7: Medical management of this guide.
UnitedHealthcare NexusACO R UnitedHealthcare NexusACO RB NexusACO RP	NexusACO R® is a tiered benefit plan where members must see their assigned network PCP and have electronic referrals submitted by their PCP before seeing another network specialist to receive the highest level of coverage. NexusACO RB® benefits are reduced without a referral. NexusACO RP® provides out-of-network benefits.³ NexusACO R and RB do not (except for emergency services). All NexusACO benefit plans are tiered.	Yes, an electronic referral from the member's PCP is required prior to receiving services from a NexusACO health care provider participating in this limited NexusACO network. See Chapter 6: Referrals of this guide.	Yes, on selected procedures, as described in Chapter 7: Medical management of this guide.



Product name ¹	How do members access physicians and health care professionals? ²	Is a referral required from the member's PCP to the network specialist?	Is the treating network physician and/or facility required to give notification when providing certain services?
UHC Complete	Members must see their PCP and have electronic referrals submitted by their PCP before seeing another network physician within the network service area to receive coverage. UHC Complete plans do not provide out-of-network benefits (except for emergency services) and members must stay within their service area to access care. See the UHC Complete Individual Plans Supplement for more information on UHC Complete plans.	Yes, an electronic referral from the member's PCP is required prior to receiving services from a participating provider. See Chapter 6: Referrals of this guide and the UHC Complete Individual Plans Supplement in this guide.	Yes, on selected procedures as described in the UHC Complete Individual Plans Supplement within this guide.

¹ The UnitedHealthcare Network may be different among commercial products in your local market. Refer to your contract to determine whether you are part of that local network.

² Physicians and health care professionals must be licensed for the health services provided and the health care services provided must be covered under the member's benefit contract.

³ The benefit level for nonemergency services from out-of-network physicians and other health care providers is generally less than that for services from network physicians and other health care providers.

⁴ For more information about the Compass service area, go to UHCprovider.com/plans.

Benefit plan types

Open access benefit plans

No referral or PCP approval is required for members to see other network providers. Prior authorization and notifications are required for certain services, described in **Chapter 7: Medical management**, with the exceptions noted in the previous table. Benefit plans vary in the type of coverage offered based on network and tier status (for tiered benefit plans only).

Gated benefit plans

Members must select and see their assigned PCP. The PCP must submit electronic referrals before a member sees another network physician; this helps ensure the highest level of coverage. Benefit plans vary in type of coverage offered based on PCP and referral requirements, network status and tier status (for tiered benefit plans only).

Tiered benefit plans

Plans define tier 1 health care providers differently. Check your tier status by visiting UHCprovider.com > Sign In > Eligibility. Some of our commercial products feature tiered benefits. NexusACO is always offered as a tiered benefit plan. Members may have lower out-of-pocket costs for services provided by a tier 1 health care provider or facility. Members with a tiered benefit plan have a Tiered Benefits identifier on the front of their ID card.

Medicare product overview tables

Medicare Advantage – Products for individuals

In 2026, UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage plan names include a unique identifier code for each plan. Please refer to the [2026 Medicare Advantage Benefit Plan Names](#) resource on [UHCprovider.com](#) for a complete list of the plan names.

Administrative services are provided by the following affiliated companies: UnitedHealthcare Services, Inc., Optum Rx or OptumHealth Care Solutions, LLC.

Behavioral health products are provided by U.S. Behavioral Health Plan, California, doing business as Optum or United Behavioral Health, operating under the brand Optum.

Product name	Medicare member's eligibility	How do members access physicians and health care professionals?	Does a primary care physician have to make a referral to a specialist?	Is the treating physician and/or facility required to give prior authorization or advance notification when providing certain services?
HMO plans • UHC MedicareMax Medicare Advantage • UHC Preferred Medicare Advantage	Members who are Medicare eligible for Part A and B, and reside in the plan's service area.	Members choose a PCP from the Medicare network of providers who can help coordinate their care.	A referral is required to see a network specialist (some exclusions may apply).	Yes, see guidelines in Chapter 7: Medical management .
HMO-POS plans • AARP Medicare Advantage • Peoples Health Choices • Peoples Health Medicare Advantage • UHC Medicare Advantage • UHC Northern Light Health • UHC Sharp Medicare Advantage • UHC The Villages Medicare Advantage		HMO benefit plans do not cover out-of-network services, except for emergency services, urgently needed services and out-of-area renal dialysis. HMO-POS benefit plans provide out-of-network coverage for some covered benefits.*	For further information, go to UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage Referral Guide, or connect with us via chat 24/7 from the UnitedHealthcare Provider Portal. For additional contact information, visit UHCprovider.com/contactus. Have the member ID and your TIN available. PCPs should coordinate care with the appropriate Medicare network specialists.	

* The plan will cover services from in-network and out-of-network providers, as long as the services are covered benefits and medically necessary. However, a member's cost-share may be higher for covered out-of-network services.

Product name	Medicare member's eligibility	How do members access physicians and health care professionals?	Does a primary care physician have to make a referral to a specialist?	Is the treating physician and/or facility required to give prior authorization or advance notification when providing certain services?
Local PPO and Regional PPO (RPPO) plans • AARP Medicare Advantage • Peoples Health Choices • Peoples Health Patriot • UHC Medicare Advantage	Members who are Medicare eligible for Part A and B, and reside in the plan's service area.	Members should choose a PCP from the Medicare network of providers who can help coordinate their care. PPO benefit plans provide out-of-network coverage for all covered network benefits.*	No, a referral is not needed.	Yes, see guidelines in Chapter 7: Medical management.

* The plan will cover services from in-network and out-of-network providers, as long as the services are covered benefits and medically necessary. However, a member's cost-share may be higher for covered out-of-network services.

Product name	Medicare member's eligibility	How do members access physicians and health care professionals?	Does a primary care physician have to make a referral to a specialist?	Is the treating physician and/or facility required to give prior authorization or advance notification when providing certain services?
Dual Special Needs Plans HMO • UHC Dual Choice • UHC Dual Complete • UHC MedicareMax Dual Complete • UHC One Care • UHC Preferred Dual Complete • UHC Senior Care Options HMO POS • Peoples Health Dual Complete • Peoples Health Secure Complete • Peoples Health Secure Health • UHC Dual Complete • UHC MedicareMax Dual Complete • UHC Preferred Dual Complete PPO, RPPO • UHC Dual Choice • UHC Dual Complete • UHC PathWays Dual Care	Members who are both Medicare and Medicaid eligible.	Members choose a PCP from the Medicare network of providers, who can help coordinate their care. HMO benefit plans do not cover out-of-network services, except for emergency services, urgently needed services and out-of-area renal dialysis. HMO-POS and PPO benefit plans provide out-of-network coverage.*	HMO/POS: A referral is required to see a network specialist (some exclusions may apply). PPO/RPPO: No, a referral is not needed. For further information, go to UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage Referral Guide, or Have the member ID card and your TIN available. PCPs should coordinate care with the appropriate Medicare network specialists.	Yes, see guidelines in Chapter 7: Medical management .

* The plan will cover services from in-network and out-of-network providers, as long as the services are covered benefits and medically necessary. However, a member's cost-share may be higher for covered out-of-network services.

Product name	Medicare member's eligibility	How do members access physicians and health care professionals?	Does a primary care physician have to make a referral to a specialist?	Is the treating physician and/or facility required to give prior authorization or advance notification when providing certain services?
Chronic Special Needs Plans HMO • UHC Complete Care Support • UHC MedicareMax Complete Care • UHC Preferred Complete Care HMO-POS • Peoples Health Complete Care • UHC Complete Care • UHC Complete Care Support PPO, RPPO • UHC Complete Care • UHC Complete Care Support	Members who have one or more of the following qualifying chronic conditions: diabetes, chronic heart failure and/or cardiovascular disorders.	Members choose a PCP from the Medicare network of providers who can help coordinate their care. HMO benefit plans do not cover out-of-network services, except for emergency services, urgently needed services and out-of-area renal dialysis. HMO-POS and PPO benefit plans provide out-of-network coverage.*	HMO/POS: A referral is required to see a network specialist (some exclusions may apply). PPO/RPPO: No, a referral is not needed. For further information, go to UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage Referral Guide, or connect with us via chat 24/7 from the UnitedHealthcare Provider Portal. For additional contact information, visit UHCprovider.com/contactus. Have the member ID card and your TIN available. PCPs should coordinate care with the appropriate Medicare network specialists.	Yes, see guidelines in Chapter 7: Medical management.

*The plan will cover services from in-network and out-of-network providers, as long as the services are covered benefits and medically necessary. However, a member's cost-share may be higher for covered out-of-network services.

Product name	Medicare member's eligibility	How do members access physicians and health care professionals?	Does a primary care physician have to make a referral to a specialist?	Is the treating physician and/or facility required to give prior authorization or advance notification when providing certain services?
Institutional Special Needs Plans (HMO-POS, PPO) • UHC Care Advantage • UHC Nursing Home Plan	Members reside in a contracted skilled nursing facility (UHC Nursing Home Plan) or they reside in a community setting and require an institutional level of care (UHC Care Advantage).	Members choose a PCP from the Medicare network of providers who can help coordinate their care. PPO and HMO-POS benefit plans provide out-of-network coverage.*	No, a referral is not needed.	Yes, see guidelines in Chapter 7: Medical management .

* The plan will cover services from in-network and out-of-network providers, as long as the services are covered benefits and medically necessary. However, a member's cost-share may be higher for covered out-of-network services.

Product name	Medicare member's eligibility	How do members access physicians and health care professionals?	Does a primary care physician have to make a referral to a specialist?	Is the treating physician and/or facility required to give prior authorization or advance notification when providing certain services?
Erickson Advantage Plans (HMO-POS) - Erickson Advantage Freedom - Erickson Advantage Liberty - Erickson Advantage Liberty no RX - Erickson Advantage Signature Special Needs Plans - Erickson Advantage Champion (Chronic) - Erickson Advantage Guardian (Institutional)	Members who reside in an Erickson Retirement Community.	Members are assigned a PCP from the Erickson Health Medical Group network of providers. The PCP coordinates their care. These HMO-POS benefit plans provide out-of-network coverage for some covered benefits.*	No, a referral is not needed.	Prior authorization is required on a select set of services for Erickson Medicare Advantage plans: 1. DME with expense greater than \$1,000 2. All out-of-network services when member requests coverage at in-network rates 3. Elective inpatient hospitalizations 4. Outpatient physical, speech and occupational therapy to members residing in long-term care facilities 5. Admission to non-Erickson home health care 6. Admission to a non-Erickson skilled nursing facility

*The plan will cover services from in-network and out-of-network providers, as long as the services are covered benefits and medically necessary. However, a member's cost-share may be higher for covered out-of-network services.

Product name	Medicare member's eligibility	How do members access physicians and health care professionals?	Does a primary care physician have to make a referral to a specialist?	Is the treating physician and/or facility required to give prior authorization or advance notification when providing certain services?
Erickson Advantage Plans (HMO-POS) (continued)				7. Routine transportation 8. Experimental and investigational services 9. Potential cosmetic services 10. Transplants
HMO plans - UnitedHealthcare Group Medicare Advantage (HMO) HMO-POS plans - Peoples Health Group Medicare (HMO-POS) - Peoples Health Group Medicare (HMO-POS) Office of Group Benefits	Members must meet all Medicare eligibility requirements as well as the employer's requirements.	Members choose a PCP from the Medicare network of providers who can help coordinate their care. HMO benefit plans do not cover out-of-network services, except for emergency services, urgently needed services and out-of-area renal dialysis. HMO-POS benefit plans provide out-of-network coverage for some covered benefits.*	A referral is required to see a network specialist (some exclusions may apply). For further information, go to UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage Referral Guide, or connect with us via chat 24/7 from the UnitedHealthcare Provider Portal. For additional contact information, visit UHCprovider.com/contactus. Have the ID card and your TIN available. PCPs should coordinate care with the appropriate Medicare network specialists.	Yes, see guidelines in Chapter 7: Medical management .

Product name	Medicare member's eligibility	How do members access physicians and health care professionals?	Does a primary care physician have to make a referral to a specialist?	Is the treating physician and/or facility required to give prior authorization or advance notification when providing certain services?
UnitedHealthcare Group Medicare Advantage (PPO)	Members must meet all Medicare eligibility requirements as well as the employer's requirements.	Members are encouraged but not required to see a PCP from the Medicare network of providers to help coordinate their care.	No, a referral is not needed.	Yes, see guidelines in Chapter 7: Medical management .

Medicare Advantage products

Individual HMO, HMO-POS and PPO plans

These plans provide all the benefits covered under Original Medicare and more. Our plans do not have limits for pre-existing conditions, and they do not require physical exams. The member may have multiple choices of health plans depending on where they live.

While exact benefits may vary, these plans may give:

- Access to medical care through a trusted network of health care providers
- Coverage for many preventive services with no copays
- Help with financial protection with annual out-of-pocket limits
- Worldwide emergency care coverage
- Medicare Part D prescription drug coverage
- Coverage for additional benefits like routine dental, vision and hearing care

Some plans do not require an additional monthly premium for this coverage. The member simply continues to pay the Medicare Part B premium unless the member has coverage through Medicaid or another third party.

Dual special needs plan

This special needs plan (SNP) meets the needs of individuals enrolled in Medicare who also qualify for Medicaid (called dual-eligible). This plan coordinates the benefits of Medicare and Medicaid.

Chronic special needs plan

This SNP is for members who have 1 or more specific severe or disabling chronic conditions. We help members manage their condition as well as their overall health and well-being.

*The plan will cover services from in-network and out-of-network providers, as long as the services are covered benefits and medically necessary. However, a member's cost-share may be higher for covered out-of-network services.

Institutional special needs plans

These SNPs are for members who reside in a contracted skilled nursing facility (institutional SNP) or who live in a community setting and require an institutional level of care (institutional-equivalent SNP).

UnitedHealthcare Group Medicare Advantage

We offer these plans to employer groups for their retired Medicare-eligible employees. They have benefits similar to the individual plans. The ID card has the employer group name and number on it. Currently, we do not offer group special needs plans.

PCP selection

For most plans, members are required to select a Medicare network PCP (some plan exclusions may apply). If not, we assign one automatically.

Changing PCP

Members may change their network PCP at any time. Changes are generally effective on the first day of the following month. Other variations may apply. The change does not affect referrals previously submitted by their PCP if the member remains in the same network.

Special Supplemental Benefits for the Chronically Ill (SSBCI)

United Healthcare provides Special Supplemental Benefits for the Chronically Ill (SSBCI) to our highest-risk Medicare Advantage plan members who meet specific criteria based on CMS guidelines. The SSBCI benefits are offered to SNP plan members who have complex chronic conditions and are at high risk for hospitalization or adverse health outcomes.

SSBCI provides access to benefits that will cover healthy food and/or utilities as part of their plan. Members may be eligible to receive SSBCI food and/or utility benefits if they have at least one of the following chronic conditions.¹

1. Chronic alcohol use disorder and other substance use disorders
2. Autoimmune disorders
3. Cancer
4. Cardiovascular disorders²
5. Chronic heart failure²
6. Dementia
7. Diabetes mellitus²
8. Overweight, obesity and metabolic syndrome
9. Chronic gastrointestinal disease
10. Chronic kidney disease
11. Severe hematologic disorders
12. HIV/AIDS
13. Chronic lung disorders
14. Chronic and disabling mental health conditions
15. Neurologic disorders
16. Stroke
17. Post-organ transplantation care
18. Immunodeficiency and immunosuppressive disorders

¹ All conditions qualify dual SNP members to enroll in SSBCI and receive food and utilities benefits, and for institutional-equivalent SNP members to enroll in SSBCI and receive food benefits only. List can be found at [cms.gov](https://www.cms.gov).

² These conditions qualify chronic SNP members to enroll in SSBCI and receive food benefits only.

19. Conditions associated with cognitive impairment: Alzheimer's disease, intellectual disability and developmental disabilities, traumatic brain injuries, disabling mental illness associated with cognitive impairment and mild cognitive impairment
20. Conditions with functional challenges and require similar services including the following: spinal cord
21. Myasthenia Gravis/myoneural disorders and Guillain-Barre Syndrome/inflammatory and toxic neuropathy
22. Chronic hypertension
23. Chronic hyperlipidemia

UnitedHealthcare will attempt to determine member eligibility for the program using claims data and records on file. If we cannot predetermine eligible conditions, the UnitedHealthcare verification team will reach out to the member's provider to obtain the verification of diagnosis of an eligible condition. Provider validation can be accepted from the member's treating provider or their office staff, either verbally or in writing.

Medical policies for Medicare Advantage members

Our MA plan Evidence of Coverage (EOC) and Summary of Benefits (SOB) list the member's covered benefits, limitations and exclusions. We use our MA medical policies to support the administration of medical benefits. We develop our MA Medical Policies with the help of:

- National coverage determination (NCD) or other Medicare guidance, e.g., Medicare Policy Benefit Manual, Medicare Managed Care Manual, Medicare Claims Processing Manual, Medicare Learning Network Matters articles
- Local coverage determination (LCD) and Local Policy articles (A/B MAC and DME MAC)
- Nationally recognized third-party, evidence-based clinical guidelines and/or internally developed clinical criteria (**Note:** In circumstances where Medicare guidelines are silent or not fully established, UnitedHealthcare may use either of these resources in accordance with Medicare rules and regulations and approved by the UnitedHealthcare Medicare Advantage utilization management committee)

The policies are subject to change based on Medicare's coverage requirements, clinical evidence, technology and evolving practice patterns. You are responsible for reviewing the CMS Medicare coverage guidance documents. If there is a conflict between our policies and the guidance documents, the CMS information controls. Our MA medical policies are available on [UHCprovider.com/policies](https://uhcprovider.com/policies) > For Medicare Advantage Plans > **Medical and drug policies for Medicare Advantage plans.**

Medical policy updates

We publish monthly editions of the Medicare Advantage Medical Policy Update Bulletin. This online resource provides notice to our network providers of changes to MA medical policies. The bulletin is posted on the first calendar day of every month on [UHCprovider.com/policies](https://uhcprovider.com/policies) > For Medicare Advantage plans > Medical and drug policies for Medicare Advantage plans > **Medicare Advantage Medical Policy Update Bulletins.**

A supplemental link to the policy updates announced in the Medicare Advantage Medical Policy Update Bulletin is also available at [UHCprovider.com/news](https://uhcprovider.com/news).

Special needs plans managed by Optum

UnitedHealthcare Dual Special Needs Plans (D-SNPs) and Chronic Condition Special Needs Plans (C-SNPs) are 2 types of Medicare Advantage Special Needs Plans. The protocols defined below establish the guidelines and process for clinical integration, cooperation and collaboration of, and with respect to, the care of members of UnitedHealthcare D-SNPs and C-SNPs managed by Optum.

These protocols are applicable to PCPs in the UnitedHealthcare network for D-SNPs and/or C-SNPs, who are treating D-SNP or C-SNP members managed by our affiliate Optum.

These protocols do not apply to D-SNP or C-SNP members who are assigned to an Accountable Care Organization based upon the member's PCP or whose PCP participates in a global capitation or risk-sharing arrangement with UnitedHealthcare.



Optum management of UnitedHealthcare D-SNP and C-SNP members includes the UnitedHealthcare At Home (UAH) Program, which is an integrated care delivery program that coordinates the delivery and provision of clinical care of members in their place of residence. When members participate in this program, their health care providers must follow a communications structure that helps ensure better coordination of their medical care.

To promote the best possible outcomes, the program supports:

- Sharing information among care team members, including performance reviews
- Tracking clinical outcomes
- Communicating evidence-based guidelines

The UnitedHealthcare At Home Program interdisciplinary care team includes an Optum-trained advanced practice clinician (ARNP/PA), the member's PCP and other health care providers as appropriate, in addition to the member and the member's family. Together, they provide care customized to the member's needs and goals of care. As part of this program, Optum clinicians:

- Conduct annual evaluations
- Provide longitudinal care management for high-risk members to address medical, behavioral and socioeconomic concerns
- Help ensure care coordination for members experiencing a care transition

The UAH program supplements care provided by our members' PCPs. It is not intended to replace the care provided by our members' PCPs. If these protocols differ from, or conflict with, other protocols in connection with any matter pertaining to members of UnitedHealthcare D-SNP or C-SNP plans managed by Optum, these protocols govern unless statutes and regulations dictate otherwise.

Protocols for UnitedHealthcare D-SNPs members managed by Optum

PCPs for UnitedHealthcare D-SNP members managed by Optum, you agree to:

- Collaborate and cooperate with the UAH program, including UAH advanced-practice clinicians and other staff assigned to UnitedHealthcare D-SNP members managed by Optum
 - Work with applicable members of the interdisciplinary care team (designated by UAH) and other treating clinicians to provide, and arrange for, the provision of covered services to UnitedHealthcare D-SNP members managed by Optum
 - Identify preferred process(es) for bidirectional communication with the UAH interdisciplinary care team, including member care needs/concerns, facilitation of scheduling, social determinate issues, responding to acute clinical and/or mental health needs, home health certifications, etc., via the appropriate communication channel (phone or secure email)
 - Initiate proactive communication to UAH, as appropriate, regarding patient needs identified in the previous bullet
- Attend quality meetings as requested by UAH; this includes monthly/quarterly/ad hoc meetings focused on comprehensiveness of patient care and ongoing coordination of such. Review information provided by UAH, including Provider Performance Reviews and tracking of clinical outcomes
 - Develop and execute action plans, targeting continual quality improvement
- Review and adhere to evidence-based guidelines to develop care plans, close gaps in care and respond to deficiencies identified in care monitoring
- Assist with care transitions, including (but not limited to) medication reconciliation, follow up visits, home health needs and prescription management
- Assess and refer patients with unmet SDoH needs and notify UAH when unmet needs are identified
- Make every effort to accept new patients who do not have an attributed PCP relationship, as patient capacity permits
- Coordinate with the UAH team to identify and engage patients who are difficult to reach and/or unable to engage
- Share up-to-date patient contact information with the UAH team

Protocols for UnitedHealthcare C-SNP members managed by Optum

PCPs for UnitedHealthcare C-SNP members managed by Optum, you agree to:

- Comply with all of the requirements of protocols for UnitedHealthcare D-SNP members managed by Optum (previous section)
- Complete a Chronic Condition Attestation, annually, for each applicable member
 - Assess each suspected or previously coded chronic condition (listed on attestation) by indicating “yes” or “no” to confirm or reject each specific diagnosis
 - List all additional chronic conditions diagnosed
 - Document all chronic conditions to the highest level of specificity, linking manifestations when applicable, per ICD-10 guidelines
 - Submit supporting documentation (progress notes, visit summary, etc.) specifically addressing each chronic condition assessed

Medicare Supplement benefit plans

AARP Medicare Select benefit plans

This Medicare Supplement product is available only to eligible AARP members who reside within the service area of a participating hospital in our Medicare Select network.

What is Medicare Select?

Medicare was not designed to cover all health care expenses incurred by older adults.

- Medicare Supplement plans cover many of the out-of-pocket costs that Original Medicare (Part A and B) do not cover, which can provide consumers with a greater sense of security
- Medicare Select plans offer consumers the benefits of a standard Medicare Supplement plan at a lower price. Unlike a standard Medicare Supplement plan, Medicare Select requires members to use a Medicare Select network hospital to receive their full benefits.

Members must use a Medicare Select network hospital for inpatient services. They can seek services from any physician of their choice that accepts Medicare and retain full Medicare benefits.

Network hospitals agree to waive the Part A inpatient hospital deductible (\$1,676 in 2025). While a network hospital waives the Part A deductible, the hospital still receives the remaining reimbursement from Medicare. UnitedHealthcare reimburses all other Medicare-eligible expenses not paid by Medicare other than the Part A deductible amounts waived under the terms of the hospital Agreement. Hospitals can arrange for automatic deposits or reimbursements.

UnitedHealthcare uses these savings to offer a Medicare Supplement plan with a lower premium. If an insured member receives inpatient services outside of the Medicare Select network, the member is responsible for the Part A deductible, unless:

- The services were emergency related
- The service was not available from a participating hospital
- The member was more than 100 miles from home

No prior authorization for medical services is required.

Medicare Select plans C, F, G and N

These Medicare plans reduce member expenses by covering some or all of the following:

- Part A inpatient hospital deductible
- Part A inpatient hospital coinsurance for days 61–90 in a Medicare benefit period
- Part A inpatient hospital coinsurance for days where lifetime reserve days are used
- Part A eligible expenses for a lifetime maximum of 365 days after all Medicare Part A benefits are exhausted
- Part B coinsurance
- Part B deductible (Select Plans C and F only)
- Daily coinsurance for days 21–100 for Skilled Nursing Facility stays
- Part A and B blood deductible for the first 3 pints of unreplaced blood
- Foreign travel emergencies
- Hospice and respite care copayments and coinsurance
- Part B excess charges for Medicare approved services (Select Plans F and G only)

Claims submission information

Electronic (preferred) – contact your clearinghouse and provide our electronic payer ID (36273). This number is specific to Medicare Select Plans and other AARP Supplemental and Personal Health Plans.

Mail – send a standard billing form along with a Part A or B Remittance Advice to:

UnitedHealthcare
P.O. Box 1878
Southampton, PA 18966-9998

To promote timely processing on all claim submissions follow standardized Medicare billing practices. Be sure to include the member's 11-digit AARP membership ID number. If you have questions or need more information, please call UnitedHealthcare Customer Service at **1-800-523-5800**.

Free Medicare education for your staff and patients

Medicare Made Clear is our public service campaign that gives consumers the information they need to select a Medicare benefit plan that is right for them. Consumers can easily access important information on topics such as the parts of Medicare, enrollment timing, what's covered (and what's not) and what they need to know to make good choices on our reference website [medicaremadeclear.com](https://www.medicaremadeclear.com).